DR LUISA FASSI

Radboud University, Behavioural Science Institute ◇ University of Cambridge, MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit

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EDUCATION

University of Cambridge *2021 - 2026*
PhD in Psychiatry

- Defended in December 2025, approved in July 2026. Affiliated with the MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit and the Department of Psychiatry.
- Research at the Digital Mental Health Group focused on studying the relationship between adolescents' social media use and mental health, supervised by Dr Amy Orben and Prof Tamsin Ford.
- Core skills: quantitative analysis of nationally representative survey data, systematic review and meta-analysis, quantitative analysis of intensive longitudinal data, qualitative study design (focus groups) and analysis, project management and study design in clinical settings.

University of Oxford *2019 - 2020*
MSc in Psychological Research

- Graduation with distinction, awarded the Humphrey Prize for the best graduate dissertation by the Department of Experimental Psychology.
- Core subjects: statistical theory and methods in R, MATLAB programming for experimental psychology, project design, research evaluation, computational modelling of brain functions.
- Thesis project supervised by Prof Roi Cohen Kadosh at the Cognition, Learning and Plasticity lab on modelling individuals' subjective beliefs in non-invasive brain stimulation studies, involving secondary quantitative analysis of experimental studies and randomised-controlled trials.

Erasmus University Rotterdam *2016 - 2019*
BSc in Psychology

- Graduation with an average of 8.3/10, ranked in the top 5 % of the 2019 bachelor cohort.
- Selection and attendance of a 400-hour Honours Program for academic excellence in the social and behavioural sciences.
- Thesis project supervised by Prof Steven A. Kushner at Kushner Lab in the Erasmus Medical Center on the effects of dentate gyrus chemogenetic activation to disentangle the neural pathways of bipolar I disorder in animal models, involving various wet lab techniques and quantitative analysis of experimental data.

RESEARCH AND CLINICAL ROLES

Postdoctoral researcher, Radboud University *September - January 2026/2027*
Project on loneliness and social contact at the Behavioural Science Institute.

Research Associate, Vrije University Amsterdam *May - July 2026*
Project focused on analyses of Instagram and TikTok data donations at the Department of Communication Science.

Academic visitor, Università della Svizzera Italiana (USI) *October - December 2025*
Research project in collaboration with the Institute of Communication and Health.

- Collaboration with Prof Peter Johannes Schulz and Dr Laura Marciano.

- Principal investigator of the HARMONY project: responsible for research design and data collection involving social media data donations, ecological momentary assessments and cognitive assessement in an adolescent mental health clinic.

Assistant Clinical Psychologist, National Health Service (NHS) *September - November 2024*
Clinical placement in the Children Services and Pediatric Medicine.

- Clinical shadowing with children and adolescents (both inpatient and outpatients), consultations with parents, involvement in clinical triage.
- Developing a workflow to assess services at the neurodevelopmental clinic, which specializes in autism and ADHD diagnoses.

PhD research visit, Radboud University *April -July 2024*
Donders Institute for Brain, Cognition and Behvaiour, Lifespan Cognitive Dynamics Lab.

- Studying the temporal dynamics of social media use and adolscent wellbeing, using secondary analysis of intensive longitudinal data with dynamic structural equation models.

Academic visitor, University of Oxford *November 2020 - October 2021*
Department of Experimental Psychology, Cognition Learning and Plasticity Lab.

- Seconday analysis of randomized controlled trial data on the effects of non-invasive brain stimulation on cognition and mental health.

Research Assistant, Erasmus Medical Center Rotterdam *November 2017 - July 2019*
Department of Molecular Psychiatry, Kushner Lab.

- Two-year part-time research internship in molecular psychiatry studying the genetic underpinnings of bipolar disorder and schizophrenia in animal models.
- Methods used: animal (mice) testing and handling, immunohistochemical stainings, histology, confocal imaging, whole-cell reconstruction, chemogenetics (DREADDs), quantitative analysis of experimental data.

Summer Research Intern, Institute of Neuroscience Alicante *July - August 2017*
Developmental Neurobiology Unit, Lopez-Bendito Lab.

Research Trainee, Erasmus University Rotterdam *January - July 2017*
Erasmus School of Social and Behavioural Sciences, 250-hour research training.

PUBLICATIONS

Turner, G., Anderson I. A., **Fassi, L.** (2025). We need transparency standards for social media research that involves companies. *PNAS* (doi).

Fassi, L., Ferguson A. M., Przybylski A. K., Ford T. J., Orben A. (2025). Social media use in adolescents with and without mental health conditions. *Nature Human Behaviour* (doi).

Fassi, L., Thomas K., Parry D. A., Leyland-Craggs A., Ford T. J., Orben A. (2024). Social media use and internalising symptoms in clinical and community adolescent samples: A systematic review and meta-analysis. *JAMA Pediatrics*, 178(8), 814-822 (doi).

Langener, A. M., Siepe, B. S., Elsherif, M., Niemeijer, K., Andresen, P. K., Akre, S., ... **Fassi, L.** Jacobson, N. C. (2024). A template and tutorial for preregistering studies using passive smartphone measures. *Behavior Research Methods*, 1-19 (doi).

Fassi, L., Hochman S., Daskalakis Z. J., Blumberger D. M., Cohen Kadosh R. (2024). The Importance of Individual Beliefs in Assessing Treatment Efficacy: Insights from Neurostimulation Studies. *eLife*, 12:RP88889 (doi).

Ghai*, S., **Fassi, L.***, Awadh, F., Orben, A. (2023). Lack of sample diversity in research on adolescent depression and social media use: a scoping review and meta-analysis. *Clinical Psychological Science*, 11(5), 759-772 (*joint first authorship, doi).

Fassi, L., Cohen Kadosh R. (2021). Letter to the Editor: How some brain stimulation studies fail to evaluate blinding adequately. *Journal of Psychiatric Research*, 137, 452–453 (doi).

Kamermans, K. L., Pouw, W., **Fassi, L.**, Aslanidou, A., Paas, F., Hostetter, A. B. (2019). The role of gesture as simulated action in reinterpretation of mental imagery. *Acta Psychologica*, 197, 131-142 (doi).

PREPRINTS, CHAPTERS AND MANUSCRIPTS IN PROGRESS

Fassi, L., Schaaf, J., Kievit, R., Marciano, L., Orben, A. (2025). Asymmetric temporal dynamics in the relationship between social media use and adolescents' wellbeing.

Fassi, L., Andersen, I. O. A., Finseras, T. R., Hjetland, G. J., Knudsen, A. K. S., Sivertsen, B., Skogen, J. C. (2025). Social media, smartphone use and internalising diagnoses in higher education: evidence from a large prospective Norwegian cohort.

Turner, G., Valdez, C., Anderson, I., Brufal, Z., Dillmann, S., **Fassi, L.**, Gunschera, L., Monarca, I., Oscar P., Richards, M., Tentori, M., Orben, A. (2025). Relating smartphone App-journeys to mental health: an exploratory network analysis approach.

Metherell. T. E., **Fassi, L.**, Rashid R., Thornton, H., Hayes, J. F., Ploubidis, G. B., Moreno-Agostino, D. (2025) Characterising the longitudinal relationship between social media use and psychiatric diagnoses in secondary care in adolescents in England (preprint on PsyArxiv).

Pownall, M., Ghai, S., **Fassi, L.**, Hayes, G., Schaaf, M., Chin, C., ... Orben, A. (2024) What does Open Science mean for educational technology research? Challenges, opportunities, and a call for research (preprint on OSF).

Chavalarias, D., De Gelder, B., Guido C., Dulong de Rosnay M., **Fassi, L.**, et al. (2023) Toward a research agenda on digital media and humanity well-being. CNRS. Directorate-General for Communications Networks, Content and Technology; European Commission (chapter 2, online).

Fassi, L., Cohen Kadosh R. (2020). Is it all in our head? When subjective beliefs about receiving an intervention are better predictors of experimental results than the intervention itself (preprint on bioRxiv).

HONOURS AND AWARDS

Psychology of Technology PhD Dissertation Award *June 2025*
Psychology of Technology Institute, 1000 € recognition for exceptional doctoral research.

Youth Mental Health Award *November 2023*
Il Circolo, London-based charity, 2000 € award for PhD research on youth mental health.

Open and Responsible Science Award *November 2022*
Erasmus Medical Center Rotterdam, 2000 € group award to the RIOT team for Open Science engagment.

Humphrey Thesis Prize for MSc Research Dissertation *July 2021*
University of Oxford, Experimental Psychology Department.

Honours Program Award *October 2017*
Erasmus University Rotterdam, School Social and Behavioural Sciences.

Research Trainee Award *October 2016*
Erasmus University Rotterdam, School Social and Behavioural Sciences.

SCHOLARSHIPS, GRANTS AND FUNDING

Brain Travel Grant *June 2026*
733 £ - funding support for travelling to the Child and Adolescent Psychiatry and Allied Professions (IACAPAP) conference

Medical Research Council, DTP Post PhD Transition Grant *June 2025*
5 280 £ - funding support for research visit to Università della Svizzera Italiana (USI), Switzerland.

Medical Research Council, DTP Flexible Funding Award *September 2024*
5 600 £ - funding support for three-month clinical placement.

JACOBS Foundation, CERES, Open Science Training *September 2023*
2 000 £ - funding support to deliver open science training to CERES (Connecting the EdTech Research EcoSystem) scholars.

Jacobs Foundation *November 2022*
14 993 $ - (Co-PI) research grant from CERES to study identity development in relation to digital technologies using qualitative methods.

Jacobs Foundation *November 2022*
14 807 $ - (Co-PI) research grant from CERES to study mobile touch interactions in adolescence using phone tracking.

Enrichment Scheme, The Alan Turing Institute *October 2022*
1 500 £ - PhD enrichment scheme from the The Alan Turing Institute of data science and AI.

JACOBS Foundation, CERES, Delivery of Open Science Training *September 2022*
2 500 £ - funding support for delivering open science training to CERES scholars.

Medical Research Council, DTP Flexible Funding Award *February 2022*
900 £ - funding to attend the Leeds School of Causal Inference.

Medical Research Council, PhD scolarship, University of Cambridge *October 2021*
105 432 £ - MRC-DTP PhD studentship.

The Carpentries Instructor Training, University of Oxford *April 2021*
700 £ - funding to become a certified instructor of data, software, and library lessons for The Carpentries.

TRAINING

Scientific Error - *7th Perspectives on Scientific Error*, 3-day workshop in Bern, Switzerland (2025)

Intensive Longitudinal Data Modelling - *Utrecht Summer School on modelling the dynamics of intensive longitudinal data*, one-week intensive course in Utrecht, Netherlands (2023)

Causal Inference - *Leeds School of Causal Inference*, one-week intensive course in Leeds, United Kingdom (2022)

Structural Equation Modelling - *SEM workshop by Ethan McCormick*, one-day course in Cambridge, United Kingdom (2022)

Data Management Skills for Open Science - *Workshop by the UK Reproducibility network, selection on a competitive basis*, one-day course in Oxford, United Kingdom (2020)

SUPERVISIONS

Master Students
Marina Picó Cabiró (University of Amsterdam), 2021

Research Assistants
Ioanna Fokas (University of Cambridge), 2025

Valerie Yap (University of Cambridge), 2024
Amelia Leyland Craggs (University of Cambridge), 2022-2024
Kirsten Thomas (University of Cambridge), 2021-2022

Bachelor Students
Emma James (Primary thesis co-supervisor, University of Cambridge), 2025

Zelda Brufal (Primary thesis co-supervisor, University of Cambridge), 2024
Anna-Lena M. Jüde (Primary thesis supervisor, Erasmus University Rotterdam), 2021
Serge Wittoeck (Primary thesis supervisor, Erasmus University Rotterdam), 2021
Ayan Huseynova (Primary thesis supervisor, Erasmus University Rotterdam), 2021

UNIVERSITY LECTURING AND SMALL GROUP TEACHING

Lecturer - *Robust Behavioural Science* Postgraduate Course, University of Cambridge (November 2024)

Lecturer - *Robust Behavioural Science* Postgraduate Course, University of Cambridge (February 2023)

Lecturer - *Basic and Translational Neuroscience* MPhil Course, University of Cambridge (November 2022)

Course Organiser and Lecturer - *An introduction to Open Science* PhD Course, Erasmus Medical Center Rotterdam (May 2022)

Undergraduate supervisor - *Adolescence*, 2nd year BA, 4 weeks course, Bachelor in Psychology, University of Cambridge (2023)

Undergraduate supervisor - *Academic Writing Skills II*, 3rd year BA, 4 weeks course, International Bachelor in Psychology, Erasmus University Rotterdam (2021)

Undergraduate supervisor - *Neuropsychological Diagnostics II*, 3rd year BA, 4 weeks course, International Bachelor in Psychology, Erasmus University Rotterdam (2021)

Private tutoring - *MyTutor*, London, BA and high-school one-to-one and group online tutoring in Statistics, Biology and Psychology (2020-2022)

Outreach tutoring - *Research Practices*, Year-12 high school students, 4 weeks course, Aim for Oxford program, University of Oxford (2020)

COMMITTEES AND BOARDS

Chair of Open Science Committee at the MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit (2022-2025)

Member of Open Science Committee at the MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit (2021-2025)

Co-chair of the RIOT Rotterdam, Science Club for Reproducible, Interpretable, Open, Transparent Research (2022-2023)

Co-chair of SfGH, the Mental Health Committee of Students for Global Health (2021-2022)

KEY CONFERENCES

ECNP, Amsterdam, Netherlands October 2025
Talk: *Social media use and youth mental health: clinical and societal implications*

ECREA, Lubjana, Slovenia September 2024
Talk: *Social media use in adolescent clinical and non-clinical populations: A registered report*

ISSBD, Lisbon, Portugal June 2024
Poster: *Social media use and adolescent internalising symptoms: a systematic review and meta-analysis*

Social Media Meeting, North Carolina, USA November 2023
Poster: *Social media use and adolescent internalising symptoms: a systematic review and meta-analysis*

SIPS, Padova, Italy June 2023
Hackaton: *Improving causal literacy across the scientific pipeline.*

Life History Research Conference, Oxford, UK June 2022
Talk: *Sample diversity in research on social media use and youth mental health: a scoping review and meta-analysis.*

Dutch Neuroscience Meeting 2019, Utrecht, Netherlands June 2019
Poster: *Behavioural effects of dentate gyrus chemogenetic activation.*

SELECTED TALKS

British Psychological Society, UK, online: *Social media use and youth mental health.*

Ofcom, UK, online: *Social media use in adolescents with and without mental health conditions.*

European Parliament, Brussels; Hearing: *Public Health Challenges in view of children and young people's wellbeing*, recorded from minute 16.24 (November 2024)

UVA seminar, University of Amsterdam, Amsterdam, Netherlands; Academic talk: *Youth mental health and social media use* (July 2024)

Donders Institute seminar, Radboud University, Nijmegen, Netherlands; Academic talk: *social media use and youth mental health: what have we missed?* (June 2024)

University of Bath, Bath, UK; Academic talk: *presentation on PhD research findings to the Child Mental Health and Development (CMHD) research groups* (April 2024)

SOS Dislessia, Bologna, Italy; Outreach: *Youth mental health and techonology use: a researcher perspective* (November 2023)

Castle Conference, Durham, UK; Outreach: *Digital Safety for children and young people* (September 2023)

Conference of Digital Media and Human Wellbeing (DIGEING), Paris; Academic talk: *Digital embedding in relation to individuals' mental health, cognition and identity formation* (December 2022)

School event at St Helen and St Katharine School, Abingdon, UK; Outreach: *Social media use from a researcher perspective* (October 2022)

Workshop on Digital Media and Human Wellbeing (DIGEING), European Commission, Venice; Outreach: *Social media use and adolescents' mental health: Which individuals are we studying?* (July 2022)

Pint of Science, London; Outreach: *Youth social media use and mental health: beyond good and bad* (July 2022)

CODING AND LANGUAGE

R, RStudio, MATLAB, SPSS, JASP, Fiji/Imagej. Softwares

Italian (mother tongue), English (fluent, C2). Languages